

Marcelo Denis Woo

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Behavioral economist and applied microeconomist combining theory, experimental methods, and causal inference. Published in *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, with job market paper on the contagion of information avoidance. Data science experience in tech analyzing large-scale datasets (900 million transactions per month) across 18 Latin American markets.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics University of Nottingham	Oct. 2021 – Feb. 2026 Nottingham, U.K.
MRes in Economics (Ranked 1st in cohort) University of Nottingham	Oct. 2020 – Sep. 2021 Nottingham, U.K.
Diploma in Machine Learning and Deep Learning Instituto Tecnológico de Buenos Aires (ITBA)	2019 Buenos Aires, Argentina
Master in Economics (Best dissertation) Universidad de San Andrés	2019 Buenos Aires, Argentina
B.A. in Economics Universidad de San Andrés	2011 Buenos Aires, Argentina

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Behavioral Economics, Applied Microeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

Heads in the Sand: Theory and Experiment on the Interdependence of Information Avoidance [PDF](#)

with Silvia Sonderegger and Fabio Tufano

We study whether the deliberate avoidance of instrumentally valuable and freely available information is interdependent across people. Agents derive direct utility from anticipating their future, state-dependent consumption, creating a motive to avoid information that induces such anticipation. Building on Bénabou (2013), our model predicts that when remaining ignorant imposes negative externalities on others' future payoffs, individuals' decisions to acquire or avoid information may exhibit strategic complementarity (making ignorance contagious), strategic substitutability (self-limiting ignorance), or be unconditional. We test these predictions in a novel experiment where participants choose whether to learn a payoff-relevant state and where remaining ignorant worsens a future payoff common to all group members. Exogenously increasing expectations about the prevalence of information avoidance raises participants' propensity of avoidance by one-third on average, consistent with contagious ignorance. This contagion appears mediated by a deterioration in anticipatory utility upon learning bad news as the expected prevalence of ignorance increases, but not upon learning good news. However, individuals vary substantially: around 40% of subjects condition their information choices on those of others, split evenly between strategic complements and strategic substitutes. Simulations show that the mixture of such types affects equilibrium prevalence of avoidance monotonically and nonlinearly. Our findings suggest that optimal incentive schemes aiming to promote the aggregate take-up of information should account for interdependencies in information decisions.

PUBLICATIONS

Discrimination with Inaccurate Beliefs and Confirmation Bias [PDF](#)

with Christian Ruzzier. *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization* 210 (June 2023): 379–90.

We examine patterns of discrimination when employers hold incorrect beliefs about the relationship between group membership and productivity, and suffer from confirmation bias when updating their beliefs. As a result, employers do not correct them fully, leading to persistent wage discrimination. Negative stereotypes generate discrimination against minority workers upon entry

to the labor market, but are not enough to have discrimination in the long run, and reversals in discrimination are possible. We also discuss whether interventions aimed at reducing discrimination would succeed if confirmation bias is an important source of discrimination, and consider segregation in an extension with heterogeneous employers.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Mercado Libre** *Latin America's leading e-commerce and fintech company* Buenos Aires, Argentina
Data Scientist, Marketing Science Mar. 2020 – Aug. 2020
- Analyzed consumer behavior across 18 Latin American markets using 900M+ monthly e-commerce and fintech transactions.
 - Built SQL pipelines and Tableau dashboards to identify market trends and inform business strategy across multiple product lines.
 - Presented data-driven insights to top management and marketing teams across multiple countries.
- Samsung Electronics** Buenos Aires, Argentina
Product Manager, Product & Marketing, Digital Appliances Division Mar. 2016 – Feb. 2020
- Achieved 20% market share (#1 market position) by developing data-driven product strategy based on market analysis, securing stakeholder adoption across sales, marketing, and supply chain teams.
 - Managed \$35M product portfolio across Argentina, Paraguay, and Uruguay, coordinating cross-functional teams across Latin America and Asia.
 - Received Best Employee Award (200+ eligible employees) for delivering time-critical product launch under complex logistical constraints, securing 15% of annual division revenue.
- Supply Chain Management Coordinator, Digital Appliances Division Mar. 2013 – Mar. 2016
- Developed forecasting process achieving >90% accuracy (vs. 70% target), contributing to subsidiary winning Global Operational Excellence Award for 16 consecutive months.
 - Enabled timely data-driven decision-making by developing automated reporting pipeline connecting ERP databases to analytical dashboards.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- IZA / University of Bonn** Bonn, Germany
Research Visit. Host: Professor [Florian Zimmermann](#) May 2025 – Jun. 2025
- University of Nottingham** Nottingham, UK
Research Assistant for Professor [John Gathergood](#) Jul. 2023 – Nov. 2023
- Contributed to project on gender inequalities in U.K. academia by building comprehensive database of 88,000 research outputs and corresponding authors, and implementing machine learning algorithm for gender classification.
- Research Assistant for Professor [Valeria Rueda](#) Nov. 2021 – Sep. 2022
- Contributed to project on [women's political activism and electoral participation](#) by building database of 11,700 U.K. parliament speeches (1910-1914) and implementing text analysis in Python.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- University of Nottingham** Nottingham, UK
Teaching Associate Oct. 2025 – Present
Economics Dissertation (supervision, computing classes, tutorials), Politics of Economics, Experimental & Behavioural Economics, Public Sector Economics
- Postgraduate Teaching Assistant (PGTA) Sep. 2021 – Jul. 2025
Applied Econometrics I & II, Quantitative Methods, Politics of Economics, Experimental & Behavioural Economics, Economics Dissertation, Introduction to Microeconomics.

CONFERENCES / PRESENTATIONS

2025: Field Days (LISER), IZA Applied Lunch seminar (IZA), CCC Meeting (University of Amsterdam), Midlands Empirical Economics Workshop (University of Leicester), Applied Micro Group (University of Nottingham), CeDEx Brown Bag (University of Nottingham)

2024: Copenhagen Network of Experimental Economics (CNEE) Conference, CeDEx Brown Bag (University of Nottingham)

AWARDS

Academic Awards

- **Best Performance in MRes** in Economics (ranked first in cohort), University of Nottingham, 2021.
- **RIDGE-Nottingham Scholarship:** full funding for 5 years (awarded to only 1 student from Latin America).
- **Best PhD student presentation**, Year 2. PhD Annual Conference, University of Nottingham, 2023.
- **Best Dissertation in Master in Economics** (selected from 40+ eligible theses), Universidad de San Andrés, 2019.
- **Teaching Excellence Award**, University of Nottingham, 2021/22 and 2022/23.

Industry Awards

- **Best employee award** for “outstanding behavior and valuable contributions to business”, Samsung Electronics, 2017 (among 200+ eligible employees).
- **Global Operational Excellence award** (key contributor for award at subsidiary level), Samsung Electronics, 2016.

COURSES

- University of Oxford: Foundations of Machine Learning, Sep. 2024.
- University of Chicago: Chicago School in Experimental Economics, Sep. 2025 (online attendee).
- Hanken School of Economics (ESA): Behavioral Field Experiments, Aug. 2024.
- Barcelona School of Economics: Randomized Controlled Trials, Jul. 2023.
- Paris School of Economics: Gender Economics, Jun. 2023.
- Stanford University: Statistical Learning in R (with distinction), Mar. 2020.

SKILLS

Econometrics & Data Science: Python, Stata, R, SQL

Experimental Platforms: Qualtrics, Lioness

Version Control & Reproducibility: Git, GitHub

Languages: Spanish (native) | English (proficient) | Korean (intermediate) | French (basic).

SERVICE

- PhD Representative, [Centre for Decision Research and Experimental Economics \(CeDEx\)](#), 2024-2025.
- Co-organizer of CeDEx Brown Bag seminars, 2022-2024.

REFERENCES

Professor Silvia Sonderegger

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Last updated on 2026-03-16